Highway Asset Infrastructure Management
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Swindon, SN1 2JH

Lead Local Flood Authority

Consultation Response

To: Planning Services

From: Lead Local Flood Authority

Date: 6th June 2022

Application number: S/COND/22/0711

Proposal: Discharge of conditions 40 (Flood Mitigation) and 41 (Surface Water - Full Site) from Outline Planning Permission S/OUT/13/1555

Location: Land North Of A420 Eastern Villages Swindon

Recommendation – Conditions not discharged

Reasons for Refusal

1. The Surface Water Management Strategy is not in-line with adopted guidance and policy such as the SuDS Vision SPD February 2017. The Strategy is also not inline with the National Planning Practice Guidance (Paragraph 079) as the proposed strategy does not give priority to SuDS throughout the development.
2. It has not been demonstrated that the development will not increase the risk of flooding elsewhere and therefore is contrary to Paragraph 159 of the National Planning Policy Framework (NPPF) and Policy EN6 of the adopted Swindon Local Plan 2026.

Detailed comments

The Brookbanks Surface Water Drainage Report makes no reference to the main adopted guidance to the NEV, the SuDS Vision SPD, adopted February 2017. As stated during the outline planning process and resent pre-application meetings, this **must** be adhered to and cannot be ignored.

The discussions had regarding the drainage throughout the pre-application meetings seem to have been ignored. The strategy is still based on large regional pond solutions rather than site and source control solutions which is not inline with local and national guidance.

A number of strategic ditches in the Rowborough area are proposed to be removed which is not acceptable and was not agreed as part of the outline process. These must be retained as they currently drain over 56 hectares of land outside of the application boundary (see Figure 1 below).

Figure 1 - Catchment falling to Rowborough

The key drainage routes were shown on the approved outline plan 1335-DR-03 Rev G shown in Figure 2 below.

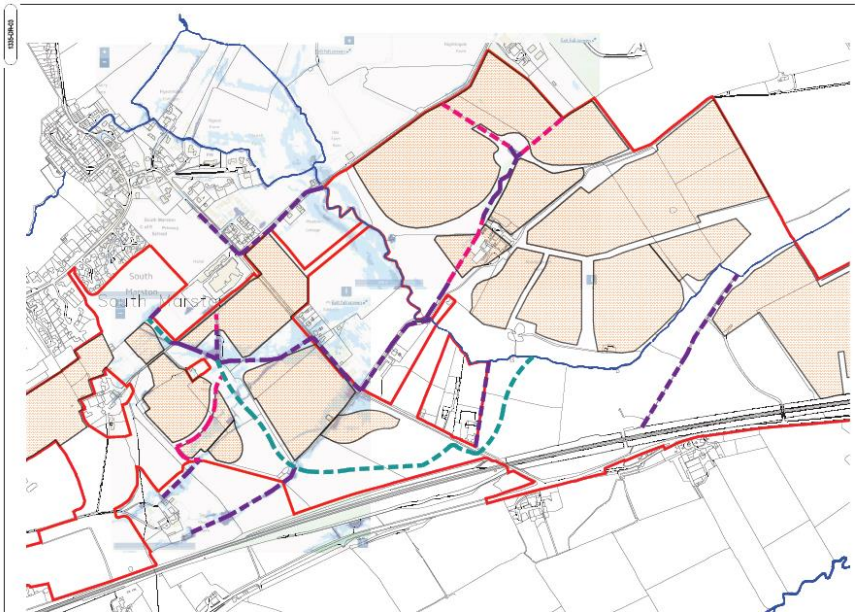

Figure 2 - 1335-DR-03 Rev G Redirection of Surface Water Flow route

The existing ditches must be retained or can be diverted through adequate above ground features.

A commitment has been made to retaining and enhancing the key existing ditch/swale network to manage the flows in the South Marston area but this is not being done in the Rowborough area.

This key strategic network must be provided and the strategy must go further in discharging flows throughout the network rather than only a few discharge points via large ponds, to ensure the existing drainage regime is maintained inline with local and national guidance.

Parameters must be set to ensure a commitment is made to deliver SuDS within the parcels through the reserved matters applications.

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